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EDUCATION	Georgia State University, Andrew Young School of Policy Studies Ph.D. <i>Economics</i> Expected 2027 M.A. <i>Economics</i> 2024 <i>Dissertation</i>: Essays on Health and Applied Development Economics <i>Committee</i>: James H. Marton (Chair), Lauren Hoehn-Velasco, Angela B. Snyder & David Wu University of Ibadan M.Sc. <i>Economics</i> 2018 University of Jos B.Sc. <i>Economics</i> 2012
ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS	Federal University Wukari Associate Lecturer, Department of Economics 2020–2022 Assistant Lecturer, Department of Economics 2018–2020
FIELDS	<i>Health Economics, Public Economics & Demographic Economics</i>
JOB MARKET PAPER	“Exploring the Differential Impact of Repealing the ACA Individual Mandate by Health Status” <i>Abstract</i>: Health insurance mandates are designed to mitigate adverse selection by encouraging enrollment among relatively healthy individuals. This paper examines how the 2019 repeal of the Affordable Care Act (ACA) individual mandate penalty affected insurance participation, Marketplace premiums, out-of-pocket premium spending, and consumer surplus by health status. Using a two-way fixed effects design, I find that the repeal increased the probability of becoming newly uninsured by 0.56 percentage points (27 percent relative to the pre-reform mean), with nearly all of the increase driven by relatively healthy consumers. Benchmark Marketplace premiums increased by approximately \$739, while average out-of-pocket premium spending decreased by \$284.60 as ACA premium subsidies offset much of the premium increase. A consumer surplus analysis shows that, without premium subsidies, relatively sick consumers bear most of the welfare losses from adverse selection. Accounting for subsidies substantially mitigates these losses, demonstrating that premium subsidies alter the distributional consequences of adverse selection.
WORKING PAPER	“Does the Tobacco 21 Minimum Legal Sales Age Policy Improve Respiratory Health? Evidence from the United States” (with M.O. Emmanuel, G. Aipoh, V.J. Dickson, E.N. Collins). Revise and Resubmit, <i>Social Science & Medicine</i> <i>Abstract</i>: Tobacco control policies are widely evaluated based on their effects on smoking behavior, but less is known about their short-term health effects. This study examines whether Tobacco 21 minimum legal sales age (MLSA) laws reduce smoking and asthma prevalence among individuals aged 18–20. Using Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS) data from 2011–2019 and variation in the timing of policy adoption across states, we find that Tobacco 21 laws significantly reduce smoking but do not lead to a statistically significant decline in asthma prevalence in the short run. Subgroup analyses suggest larger reductions in asthma prevalence among Black young adults and 19-year-olds, although these estimates are statistically insignificant. These findings suggest that reductions in smoking following Tobacco 21 laws may not immediately translate into measurable improvements in respiratory health and highlight the importance of considering the timing of health effects when evaluating tobacco control policies.

WORKS IN PROGRESS	1. “Spillover Effects of Prescription Drug Insurance on Informal Caregiving: Evidence from Social Security Disability Insurance (SSDI) Medicare Recipients” 2. “Do Non-Financial Incentives Improve Maternal Health Outcomes? Evidence from Nigeria’s Abiye (Safe Motherhood) Program”	
PRE-DOCTORAL PUBLICATIONS	1. The Determinants of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises’ (MSMEs) Performance in Nigeria: Evidence from Business Enterprise Survey (with Rosemary A. Anga and Charity G. Isa). <i>Development Bank of Nigeria Journal of Economics and Sustainable Growth</i>, 3(1), 21–45, 2020. [Link] 2. Public Debt Sustainability in Nigeria after the exit from Paris Club: The role of Structural Breaks (with Adewumi Otonne and Jane O. Asogwa). <i>Acta Universitatis Danubius (Economica) Journal</i>, 15(7), 148-163, 2019. [Link] 3. Predicting Exchange Rate with Commodity Prices: New Evidence from Westerlund and Narayan (2015) Estimator with Structural Breaks and Asymmetries (with Afees A. Salisu, Wasiu Adekunle, and Wasiu A. Alimi). <i>Resources Policy</i> 62(1), 33-56, 2019. [Link]	
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Georgia State University Research Assistant for Dr. Pierre Nguimkeu, Department of Economics Research Assistant for Dr. David Ribar, Georgia Policy Lab Research Assistant for Dr. Vjollca Sadiraj, Experimental Economics Lab Research Assistant for Dr. Lorenzo Almada, Department of Economics Research Assistant for Dr. Daniel Kreisman, Georgia Policy Lab Research Assistant for Dr. Amy Eremionkhale, Department of Economics Center for Econometrics & Applied Research (CEAR) Research Assistant for Dr. Afees Salisu Summer 2026 Fall 2025 Fall 2025 Summer 2024 Fall 2023 Summer 2023 2018–2019	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Instructor of Record, Georgia State University Data Science for Economists Course Evaluation: 4.9 / 5.0 Teaching Assistant, Georgia State University Econometrics II (Ph.D.) Data Science for Economists (Undergraduate) Principles of Macroeconomics (Undergraduate) Applied Statistics (M.A.) Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate) Instructor of Record, Federal University Wukari Economic Planning (Undergraduate) Taxation & Fiscal Policy (Undergraduate) Advanced Macroeconomics II (Undergraduate) Intermediate Macroeconomics II (Undergraduate) Mathematics for Economists I (Undergraduate) Introduction to Microeconomics (Undergraduate) Summer 2026 (12 students) Spring 2026 Spring 2025 Spring 2024 Spring 2024 Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2024 Fall 2021 Spring 2021 Spring 2021 Spring 2020 Fall 2019, Spring 2022 Fall 2019, Spring 2021, Fall 2021	
ACADEMIC AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	Georgia State University Center for Economic Analysis of Risk (CEAR), Dissertation Fellowship APPAM Equity and Inclusion Fellowship E.D. Jack Dunn Fellowship and Research Award University of Ibadan Tertiary Education Trust (TET) Fund Fellowship Award University of Jos Tony Elumelu Foundation Prize for best graduating student in Economics Chevron Nigeria National University Merit Scholarship Award 2025–2026 2025 2024, 2025 2017–2018 2013 2009–2012	

WORKSHOPS & CONFERENCES (*Scheduled)	2026: Southern Economic Association (SEA) Conference, Houston, TX*; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Conference, Boston, MA*; Georgia State University PhD Summer Symposium, American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Conference, Minneapolis, MN; EconNect Africa Seminar Series (Virtual); Georgia State University Graduate Research Conference, Atlanta, GA. 2025: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Conference, Seattle, WA; Realist Economic Evaluation Conference, Atlanta, GA; Atlanta Economics PhD Students Symposium, Emory University; American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Conference, Nashville, TN; Empirical Methods in Social Science Research Workshop, Clemson University, SC; Georgia State University Graduate Research Conference, Atlanta, GA.	
UNDERGRADUATE STUDENT SUPERVISION	Godwin E. Ekpe, “The Effects of Oil Price Volatility on Economic Growth in Nigeria” 2021 Blessing I. Samuel, “The Determinants of Public Healthcare Spending in Nigeria”, 2021 Mathias Rimamsanati, “Public Health Expenditure and Life Expectancy in Nigeria”, 2021	
UNIVERSITY SERVICE	Federal University Wukari Secretary, Economics Department Board 2019–2022 Member, Undergraduate Project Topic Review Committee 2021–2022 Economics Department Rep, University Quality Assurance Committee 2021–2022	
SERVICE & LEADERSHIP	President, Graduate Christian Fellowship at Georgia State University 2024–Present Reviewer, ASHEcon Conference Abstracts 2025–2026 Reviewer, Etinosa Oghogho Foundation Undergraduate Scholarship 2024–2025 Judge, Georgia State Undergraduate Research Conference (GSURC) 2024–2025	
PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP	<i>American Economic Association (AEA), Nigerian Economic Society (NES), Royal Economic Society (RES), American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), Association for Public Policy and Management (APPAM), Southern Economic Association (SEA).</i>	
REFEREE SERVICE	<i>SN Business & Economics (1x), Energy Research & Social Science (1x)</i>	
OTHER EMPLOYMENT	Financial Analyst, United Capital Plc, Lagos Island, Nigeria 2015–2015 Economics Teacher, National Youth Service Corps (NYSC), Ibadan, Nigeria 2013–2014	
SOFTWARE & PROGRAMMING	Microsoft Office, Stata, RStudio, LaTeX, Beamer	

REFERENCES

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